

- (b) shall have power to authorise the representation before them of any person appearing to them to be interested to be by counsel or solicitor or otherwise, or to refuse to allow such representation.

Short title. **3.** This Act may be cited as the Tribunals of Inquiry (Evidence) Act, 1921.

CHAPTER 8.

An Act to make provision for the cessation of the Ministry of Munitions and the Ministry of Shipping. [24th March 1921.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :—

Provisions
as to transfer
of property,
&c. on
cessation of
Ministries.

5 & 6 Geo. 5.
c. 51.
6 & 7 Geo. 5.
c. 68.

1.—(1) Any Order in Council made under section six of the Ministry of Munitions Act, 1915, or made under section thirteen of the New Ministries and Secretaries Act, 1916, fixing a date earlier than the termination of a period of twelve months after the conclusion of the present war as the date on which the office of Minister of Munitions and the Ministry of Munitions or the office of Shipping Controller and the Ministry of Shipping are to cease may—

- (a) vest and transfer or provide for the vesting and transfer in and to any Government department or departments of any property, rights and liabilities held, enjoyed, or incurred by the Minister of Munitions or the Shipping Controller (or by any person who has held the office of Minister of Munitions or Shipping Controller);
- (b) provide for the discontinuance of the powers of the Minister of Munitions or the Shipping Controller under the Defence of the Realm Regulations and any other powers;

- (c) provide for the transfer to some other Government department or departments (notwithstanding anything in section six of the Ministry of Munitions Act, 1915, or section thirteen of the New Ministries and Secretaries Act, 1916) of such of the powers or duties of the Minister of Munitions or the Shipping Controller as are not so discontinued as aforesaid; and for the exercise or performance of the powers or duties so transferred by the department or under the direction of the department by any organisation which may be established in manner provided by the Order, and for enabling any such organisation to sue and be sued; and
- (d) provide for the Government department to which any such property, rights, liabilities, powers or duties are transferred being deemed in law to be, as respects such property, rights, liabilities, powers or duties, the successor of the Minister of Munitions or the Shipping Controller: Provided that any organisation established under any such Order shall cease to exist not later than the thirty-first day of March, nineteen hundred and twenty-four.

(2) Any such order may contain such consequential, incidental, and supplemental provisions (including provisions as to the transfer of officers) as may appear necessary or proper for the purposes of the Order, and shall have effect as if enacted in this Act, but may be varied by a subsequent Order: Provided that any such subsequent Order shall be laid before both Houses of Parliament as soon as may be after it is made, and, if either House within twenty-one days on which the House has sat next after the Order is so laid presents an address to His Majesty against the Order, His Majesty in Council may revoke the Order without prejudice to anything previously done thereunder.

2. This Act may be cited as the Ministries of Munitions and Shipping (Cessation) Act, 1921.
